Caro-Kann Advance - my lines

Caro-Kann, Advance Variation -- notes for blitz (as Black)

• 1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5

Main choice: 3...Bf5

• 4. Nf3 e6 5. Be2 c5 -- the short system. Aim for ...Nc6, ...Qb6, pressure on d4.

• 4. h4 h5 -- don't panic. 5. c4 is the critical try; 5...e6 6. Nc3 Ne7.

• 4. Nc3 e6 5. g4 Bg6 6. Nge2 c5 -- sharp. I keep losing here in 3+0. Option: 4...h5!? to avoid g4 lines.

Plans to remember

Structure	My plan
White plays c3, Bd3	trade light-squared bishops, then ...c5
White castles queenside	...c5 and ...Qa5 fast; push b-pawn
e5 pawn overextended	...f6 break only after development

Mistakes from recent games

• Grabbing b2 with the queen when White has Nc3 and Rb1 tempo. Twice in December.

• Playing ...c5 before ...Nc6 when d4xc5 hits with tempo.

• Flagging in won endgames: premove less, think on opponent's time.